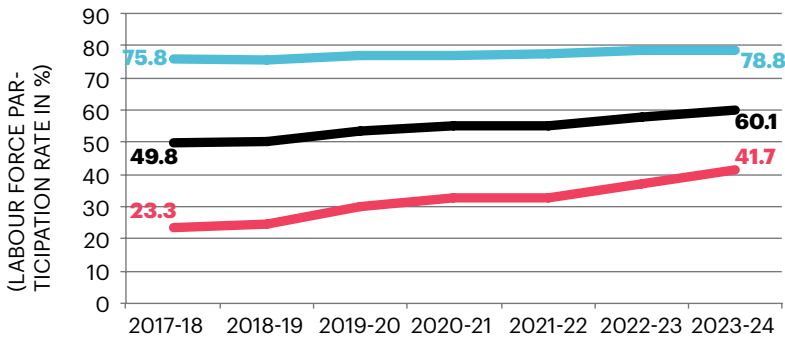


MILES TO GO

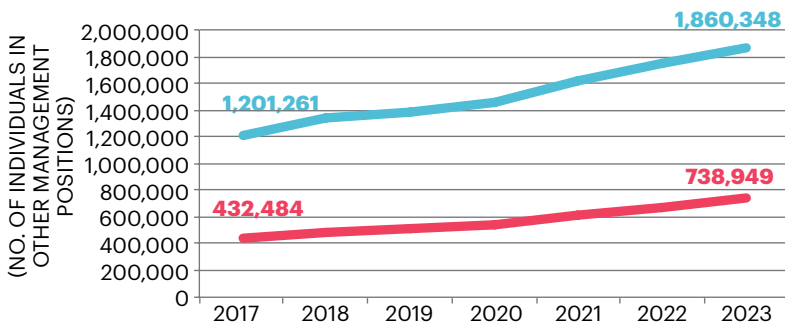
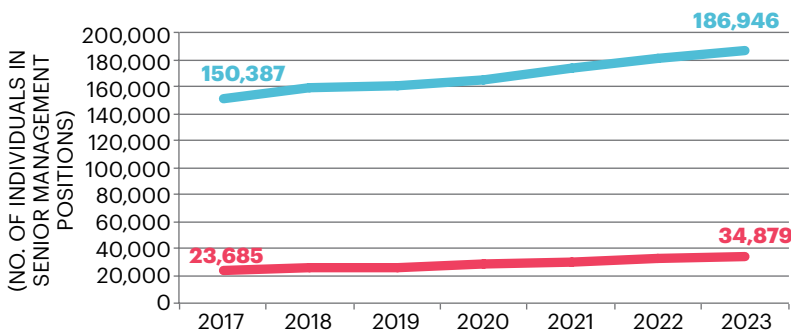
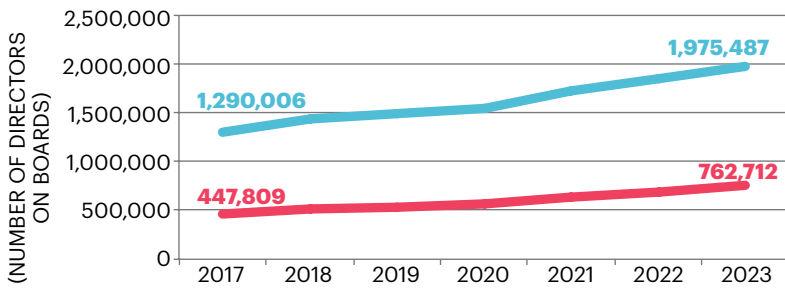
• Women's labour force participation rate has increased to 41.7% in 2023-24 from 23.3% in 2017-18; but most of this is in self-employment



MALE FEMALE ALL INDIA **NOTE** LABOUR FORCE PARTICIPATION RATE IN USUAL STATUS FOR PERSONS OF AGE 15 YEARS AND ABOVE, **SOURCE** ANNUAL REPORT PLFS JULY 2023- JUNE 2024

WOMEN IN INDIA INC.

• The proportion of women in senior roles in India Inc. is slowly rising but it remains much lower than the number of men in such positions



MALE FEMALE **SOURCE** MEN AND WOMEN IN INDIA 2023/MOSPI

and childcare, to take care of ageing in-laws and parents, as well as on the transfer of their spouses to other cities.

Rituparna Chakraborty, Co-founder of staffing firm TeamLease and an independent director on the boards of several companies, lists out various constraints for women workers—including infrastructure, safety and transportation—that can impact mobility and willingness to move out of homes to work. “Further, our entire support system for working women who want to or already have children is broken. Nuclear families are more prevalent and crèches and childcare are few and far between,” she says.

Global professional services firm Aon, in its ‘2024 Voice of Women Study India’ summed up these challenges and revealed that 42% of the women surveyed mentioned facing bias or potential bias at work, while 37% revealed that they have experienced insensitive behaviour. In addition, 6% of the women (more than 1,400) in the survey responded that they had faced sexual harassment at least once, yet less than half officially reported the incident to their employer.

“Working mothers had their own challenges, with 75% responding that they faced a career setback of one to two years after maternity leave and close to 40% said going on maternity leave had a negative impact on pay and their role changed to something they did not prefer,” said the survey.

It also found that there is increasing bias as women progress in their careers as 34% of those in senior management and leadership roles indicated facing discrimination compared to 17% of those in entry level roles. The survey covered 24,000 professional women across 560 companies, to identify